

ICED TEA

SERVES 4

In the United States, tea is most often enjoyed sweet and cold. Ask for tea at a restaurant and be prepared to be served a tall glass of icy cold tea. Here is a simple recipe to make your own at home.

Iced tea is new to some parts of the world, but has been consumed in America for over a century. The invention of iced tea is attributed to Richard Blechynden, a tea company representative from England who was promoting Indian tea at the St. Louis World's Fair in Missouri in 1904. The weather was unbearably hot at the fair, and the small cups of hot tea he was

offering for sampling were not generating much interest. So he added ice to the tea and it became a big hit.

There are two types of classic iced tea—sweet iced tea, popular in the South, and unsweetened iced tea (without sugar), popular in the North. A lemon wedge is sometimes added to either. This version of iced tea is a favorite south of the Mason-Dixon line.

YOU WILL NEED

Ingredients

6 tsp loose black tea
2 cups boiling water
pinch of baking soda
 $\frac{3}{4}$ cup sugar
2 lemons, sliced, to serve (optional)
ice cubes

Cool teas were enjoyed in the Southern states as early as the 1830s and usually involved the addition of Champagne to a cooled green tea.



1 Place the tea leaves in a teapot and add the boiling water. Steep for 15 minutes to create a strong infusion.



2 Pour the tea into a heatproof pitcher using a strainer.